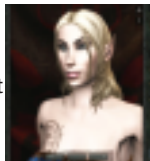


Size Does Matter

Some *Age of Conan* players were in for a rude shock of sorts when their female character's bust sizes decreased from buxom to run of the mill. Due to the public outcry that followed, the games developers announced that they were working on a fix to restore the sizes to the previous dimensions



Power of Touch

The popularity of the iPhone has provided impetus to an entirely new breed of pornography—one that is optimised for iPhones. The Web sites that host smut are made looking at the touch screen capability of the device. And with the 3G iPhone hitting the shelves, the scene seems to get more steamier.



Escape

NAME GAME

Mail Without G

In the world of business, names are everything, especially trademarks. Companies go through a lot of trouble to safeguard their identity from unscrupulous operators who want to piggyback on the hard earned reputation. However in this case the tables were turned, with a small time guy taking successfully on the giant search giant Google.

If you are a German, or was passing through Germany these days you would not be able to access Gmail by typing www.gmail.com. Instead of having to type in their user name and password, users were greeted by a message that apologised for not letting users to log in and check their

mail the usual way. No hackers had broken into the homepage, in case fearful and cautious users were pressing alarm bells. The apparent disfigurement was done by Google, that



Illustrations: Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

recommended users to use www.mail.google.com. Here also, Google had no right to link to the Gmail page and the hapless users were forced to copy-paste the URL into the address bar to access their mails.

Google had a long standing feud with a local venture capitalist named Daniel Giersch, who owns the trademark to a paid e-mail service called GMail. This was registered years before Google dreamed up the name for its e-mail service, so nobody could accuse him of being a copycat. Google had already lost the case that Giersch had brought against it and was fined for illegally using a trademark.

Google has no plans on what steps it will take in the future to resolve this unsightly mess. However, it has said that

Whatever Happened To... Second Life

A virtual world might be a dream come true for many people.

Second Life is still very active today. The claims of its popularity are still highly doubtful. There was a sudden influx of companies starting up their online stores on *Second Life*, but there are some that have started turning their backs to them. Pontiac and Wells Fargo are just some of these companies. AOL too left, but it hasn't given up on the idea of marketing and economics in a virtual world. It decided to join a *Second Life* competitor—www.there.com. There were even incidences of properties being bought and sold. Virtual real estate prices came crashing down.

A parallel universe is the MMORPG market, where the younger audience prefers to play with others. Besides, many have found *Second Life* to be a very harrowing experience. In India, anyway, staying online continuously on a fast connection is quite difficult.

Another major concern is the kind of prohibited content that is posted, and the happenings in the virtual world. To tackle this problem, users under the age of 18 prohibited from joining. Today, most of *Second Life*'s income comes from the larger companies, rather than the low paid user group.

We wonder if *Second Life* will shut shop soon.

Win!

My Desktop

No Winner!
Better luck next time!

Participate in this contest and win next month

.net Interview Questions

by Nagaraju B
Published by

WILEY-INDIA



Send us your desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.

DigiPick of the month

The age of the Terabyte!

Last month's winner:
Jerin Pallipeedikayil
Kerala

Participate and win next month:
The Essential Guide to User Interface Design
by Wilbert O. Galitz
Published by

WILEY-INDIA



WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with "DigiPick" in the subject line, mentioning your postal address, on or before the 20th of this month to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.



there will not be any degradation in service and all features would be supported in the German version of Gmail.

That should give the Germans some consolation, after they have gotten used to the new URL.

STEAL ALL

I Kid You Not

With all the heat and dust over illegal filesharing issue people would expect musicians to zealously guard their share of royalties and milk each and every compact disc for all its worth. There have been notable exceptions, with bands like Nine Inch Nails and artists like Radiohead giving away music for free. However Kid Rock has gone into entirely different territory by recommending fans that they steal his music!

In a "public service announcement" that was posted to YouTube (you can

watch it here: <http://tinyurl.com/59ofda> in case you are interested) by Kid Rock he announced that since he was so stinking rich it didn't matter if people illegally downloaded his songs. He probably gladdened the hearts of anarchists and anti establishment types when he said that big corporations were evil. His advice to viewers was to steal anything that caught their fancy. From laptops to iPods to cars to oil, everything was fair game. His contention is that since big corporations were sitting on billions of dollars of cash they would not miss the one or two missing items on their inventory. Bill Gates and Steve Jobs were particularly picked on as people to target, on account of their vast "fortunes".

Kid Rock, unlike many artists doesn't sell his music on iTunes as he feels the system is biased against the artists. The rap rocker also says that the Internet is a way to settle scores with

record companies who have been ripping off both performers and customers with ridiculous prices.

While most people would dismiss the video as harmless comedy there is a danger that some idiots might really believe what their idol said and attempt a spree of shopliftings and car-jackings across the world. We hope that Kid Rock has a plan in hand when these luckless sods are chucked into the penitentiary.

ENGLISH LESSONS

Fun With Nintendo

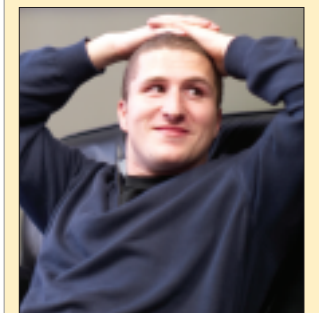
Now your parents won't crib any more when they see you glued to the addictive hand-held gaming console: Nitendo DS or popularly abbreviated as NDS or simply DS. As the doctor always ordered, fun and games should always be a proper decoction and it's not long

People Who Changed Computing

Shawn Fanning

File sharing and P2P may be pretty common now, but back in the day when Napster was launched, the idea was pretty revolutionary.

Born in 1980, Fanning was a computer freshman student at Northeastern



Shawn Fanning

University, when he conceived the idea of Napster. By his own admission Napster's inspiration came from his dorm mate who had trouble finding MP3s of his favourite songs on different Web sites. The program consisted of two parts: server and client, with the server containing indexed list of files available for sharing by users. Napster went prime time in 1999.

The file sharing service was free and news spread by word of mouth to become a huge hit. In a short time Napster grew to a user-base of millions of people, with hundreds of thousands simultaneously using the service.

Later, Fanning founded a company that focussed on the distribution of legal music called Snocap. However the company was not a success and was bought by imeem.